

Leave and Time-Off Policy

TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Enterprise Policy & Knowledge Base

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Document purpose

This controlled document defines company-wide guidance, procedures, responsibilities, approval rules, exceptions, and frequently asked questions. It is written as an operational reference for employees, managers, HR, IT, and support teams.

Important note

This is a fictional enterprise document created for the AI Document Intelligence & Enterprise Knowledge Assistant portfolio project. It is not an actual TechNova corporate policy and must not be used as legal, HR, financial, or security advice.

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Purpose and Scope

Policy intent

This policy defines the standard company leave framework for eligible TechNova employees. It covers planned leave, unexpected absence, approval responsibilities, balances, carry-forward, and selected special leave situations.

Leave is intended to support rest, personal needs, health, family responsibilities, and statutory or company-approved situations. Employees should plan leave responsibly so business continuity is maintained.

Eligibility

Unless a separate employment arrangement states otherwise, permanent employees are eligible for the standard leave framework after joining. Interns, consultants, and contract personnel may follow the terms of their engagement.

Leave balances are maintained in the HR system. Where a balance shown by the system conflicts with an approved HR correction, the corrected HR record is treated as authoritative.

Leave Categories

Casual Leave

Eligible employees receive 12 casual leave days per calendar year. Casual leave is intended for short-duration personal needs and planned or unexpected situations that do not require a long absence.

Casual leave is normally requested in advance when foreseeable. For an unexpected situation, the employee should inform the manager as soon as reasonably possible.

Sick Leave

Eligible employees receive 12 sick leave days per calendar year. Sick leave should be used when an employee is unable to work because of illness or recovery.

For extended absence, HR may request supporting medical documentation in accordance with the applicable process and privacy requirements.

Earned Leave

Eligible employees accrue 18 earned leave days per calendar year, subject to joining date, attendance, applicable local rules, and the HR system calculation.

Earned leave is generally intended for planned longer breaks and should be requested sufficiently early to allow workload planning.

Entitlements

Annual allocation

Standard annual allocations are 12 casual leave days, 12 sick leave days, and 18 earned leave days for an eligible full-year employee. The HR system prorates certain balances for employees joining partway through the year.

Leave entitlement can differ where local statutory requirements or an employee's appointment terms provide a more favorable rule.

Half-day and partial-day leave

Where supported by the HR system, employees may request leave in half-day increments. The minimum unit and treatment of partial days may vary by leave category.

Employees should not split leave artificially to bypass approval or attendance requirements.

Application and Approval

Request process

Planned leave should normally be submitted at least 3 working days before the intended start date. For longer leave of five or more consecutive working days, employees should provide additional planning notice where practical.

The employee selects the leave category, dates, and reason where required. The manager reviews team coverage and approves or rejects the request in the HR system.

Emergency absence

When an emergency prevents advance submission, the employee should notify the manager or designated team contact as soon as possible. The leave record should be regularized in the HR system when the employee returns or when access becomes available.

Silence or unexplained absence is not treated as approved leave.

Approval responsibility

Managers should make decisions consistently and consider business continuity, prior commitments, team capacity, and the employee's available balance. Approval should not be unreasonably delayed.

HR may review patterns of leave misuse, repeated unregularized absence, or disputes about entitlement.

Carry Forward and Encashment

Carry forward

Up to 12 unused earned leave days may be carried into the next calendar year, subject to applicable local rules and the employee's category. Casual and sick leave generally do not carry forward unless a local or specific employment rule states otherwise.

Balances are subject to year-end processing in the HR system. Employees should review balances before the end of December and raise discrepancies promptly.

Encashment

Earned leave encashment may be available at separation or in limited company-approved circumstances. The calculation and eligibility depend on the applicable policy and statutory requirements.

Casual and sick leave are not ordinarily encashed.

Sick Leave and Medical Documents

Short absence

For short sickness, the employee should notify the manager and submit sick leave through the HR system. A medical certificate is not normally required for a single short absence unless the manager or HR has a documented reason to request one.

Employees should not share detailed medical information with coworkers. Supporting documents should be submitted only through the approved HR process.

Extended illness

For extended absence, HR may coordinate a return-to-work process and request appropriate documentation. The company will handle employee information according to its privacy and access controls.

Parental and Special Leave

Parental leave

Eligible employees may receive maternity, paternity, adoption, or other parental benefits according to applicable law and company policy. Employees should contact HR early to understand the current entitlement for their situation.

Because statutory entitlements may depend on location and circumstances, HR confirms the applicable rule rather than relying on a generic number in this policy.

Bereavement and compassionate leave

Eligible employees may receive up to 5 working days of compassionate leave for the death of an immediate family member, subject to HR verification and applicable local requirements.

Additional unpaid or earned leave may be requested when the approved compassionate leave period is insufficient.

Personal emergency

Managers may approve short emergency absence using available leave categories where appropriate. The employee should regularize the record promptly.

Holidays and Weekly Offs

Holiday calendar

HR publishes an annual holiday calendar by location. Employees assigned to customer projects may follow a different working calendar where contractually required.

A public holiday that falls during approved leave is treated according to the applicable holiday and leave rules for the employee's location.

Weekly offs

Weekly rest days are determined by the employee's assigned schedule. Shift teams may have different weekly off patterns.

Leave During Notice

General rule

Leave during notice is not automatically prohibited, but approval remains subject to business continuity and the employee's appointment terms.

Managers may require reasonable handover before approving planned leave during notice. Unapproved absence during notice may be treated as an attendance or conduct issue.

Handover

Employees should document active tasks, deadlines, access dependencies, customer contacts, and known risks before extended leave or separation.

Exceptions and Administration

Policy exceptions

Any exception should be approved by HR and, where appropriate, the relevant business leader. Informal manager messages do not automatically change the company-wide entitlement.

Where local law provides a greater statutory entitlement, the statutory requirement applies.

Record correction

If an employee believes the HR balance is incorrect, they should raise a ticket with dates and supporting approval records. HR may review attendance, prior approvals, and payroll records before correcting the balance.

Examples

Example 1: planned casual leave

An employee wants one day off next Friday. The employee submits a casual leave request at least 3 working days before Friday, checks the available balance, and waits for manager approval.

Example 2: unexpected sickness

An employee becomes sick in the morning and cannot work. The employee informs the manager promptly, submits sick leave when possible, and provides documentation only if required by the applicable process.

Example 3: longer planned break

An employee plans ten working days of vacation. Because the absence is long, the employee discusses coverage with the manager, submits the request early, and documents handover items.

Frequently Asked Questions

How many casual leaves are available per year?

The standard entitlement is 12 casual leave days per calendar year for an eligible full-year employee.

How many sick leaves are available?

The standard entitlement is 12 sick leave days per calendar year for an eligible full-year employee.

How many earned leaves are available?

The standard annual allocation is 18 earned leave days, subject to eligibility, proration, local rules, and the HR system calculation.

How early should planned leave be requested?

Normally at least 3 working days in advance. Longer leave should be discussed earlier to support workload planning.

Can casual leave be carried forward?

Generally no, unless a local or specific employment rule provides otherwise.

Can earned leave be carried forward?

Up to 12 unused earned leave days may be carried forward, subject to applicable rules.

Can I take leave during notice period?

It may be possible with approval, but business continuity and appointment terms apply.

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End of controlled document